

Chapter 147-3

Gu Yixue raised an eyebrow and teased with a light laugh: "You dare to act in my production without even knowing which role you're playing?"

"I hadn't even seen the script before coming, yet I still came, didn't I?" Liang Shi countered lightly.

Gu Yixue nodded: "Quite bold."

Liang Shi smiled: "It's alright. After all, it's a production by an internationally renowned director—there's no way I'd be at a loss."

Gu Yixue curled her fingers and tapped them on the table a few times: "Which role do you want to play?"

Hearing this, Liang Shi said: "Guan Qingmin."

Liang Shi had never challenged this type of role before. She felt her personality was somewhat similar to Guan Qingmin's—both were the slightly wooden type, and both yearned for freedom.

She could portray that feeling of being confined.

But Gu Yixue said: "You'll play Huang Shan."

Liang Shi: "....."

"Is there a problem?" Gu Yixue asked her.

Liang Shi: ".....No."

It was obvious that Huang Shan had far more scenes than Guan Qingmin.

In fact, Guan Qingmin's character existed to highlight Huang Shan's decisiveness and fearlessness.

Compared to Huang Shan, Guan Qingmin was indeed somewhat flat as a character. Her best moment was only at the end, in the scene where she handed over the gun.

And that was precisely the scene Liang Shi had her eye on.

In that moment, she would have enough space to express Guan Qingmin's emotions.

—Because I love you, I can place my life in your hands and trust you unconditionally.

The character would be elevated in that instant.

But Gu Yixue said: "You're more suited for Huang Shan."

Liang Shi: "....."

Liang Shi felt that Gu Yixue didn't understand her well enough, but she was also willing to challenge this role.

And she trusted Gu Yixue's vision and judgment.

Sometimes actors weren't as perceptive about their own positioning as directors were.

Besides, Liang Shi had a creed as an actress: Never play Liang Shi.

This was a very important point.

An actor should become whoever they play, not make every character seem like themselves.

She readily accepted Gu Yixue's suggestion. Before she could say anything more, the others began arriving one after another.

The first to arrive was Sun Chengcheng. She wore a white turtleneck sweater paired with an off-white long coat, looking pure and cute. Her eyes were especially striking—a light brown color.

Though that was from colored contact lenses.

Because Liang Shi had met her before, and her eyes were the darker type—eyes full of spirit and vitality.

Two others came after her, one named Qi Tang and one named Tang Zui.

Their names were quite coincidentally connected¹. The two looked like different types, but each had their own distinctive features.

The moment Sun Chengcheng came in and saw Liang Shi, she immediately showed a look of disgust.

But upon seeing Gu Yixue, she put away the disgust and greeted Gu Yixue with a smile: "Hello, Director."

Gu Yixue nodded slightly and said expressionlessly: "Read the script first."

Gu Yixue, who got straight to the point, was very cool. So while waiting for them to read the script, Liang Shi read through it once more.

After waiting about ten minutes or so, Sun Chengcheng was moved to tears. While wiping her tears and sniffing, she asked Gu Yixue: "Director, why is it a tragedy?"

Gu Yixue: "....."

As if not expecting such a question, Gu Yixue paused for two seconds before answering coldly: "Because I like it."

This was also Gu Yixue's first BE work.

Sun Chengcheng had just wiped away her tears and hadn't had time to compose herself when she heard Gu Yixue ask: "Who do you plan to play?"

Sun Chengcheng answered without thinking: "Huang Shan."

Gu Yixue: "....."

Two seconds later, Gu Yixue said decisively: "You'll play Guan Qingmin."

Sun Chengcheng: "?"

She instinctively looked toward Liang Shi, her expression very unfriendly.

But Liang Shi didn't pay attention. She lowered her head and continued reading the script, only glancing at Sun Chengcheng with a look of disdain as her eyes swept past.

She was channeling that energy she used when playing Zhao Xuning—it seemed to work quite well.

Because Sun Chengcheng immediately stopped crying.

Sun Chengcheng questioned Gu Yixue: "Director, why?"

Gu Yixue paused again: "There is no why."

Sun Chengcheng: "....."

Footnotes:

¹ Names coincidentally connected: The two names Qi Tang (祁唐) and Tang Zui (唐醉) both contain the character "Tang" (唐), making them sound like they share a connection or could be related, hence the comment about their names being "quite coincidentally connected" (有緣分, literally "having fate/destiny together").